How To Train Lora / Fine-Tune Anima Base Model

Anima Portable Standalone Trainer — Part 3: How to Finetune a Model

This is Part 3 of a 3-part series.

- Part 1: Installation
- Part 2: How to Train a LoRA
- **Part 3: How to Finetune a Model** ← You are here

⚠️ **Resource Notice: Due to recent updates on the CivitAI platform, some file attachments in this article may no longer be visible or accessible. For all resources related to this article — including additional tools, files, and miscellaneous assets — please refer HERE**

What Is Full Finetuning?

Unlike LoRA which trains a small adapter on top of the model, full finetuning trains the entire model weights directly. This requires significantly more VRAM, a much larger dataset, and is best done on a cloud GPU. For this reason, **RunPod** is strongly recommended for finetuning.

🗂️ Step 1 — Prepare Your Dataset

Finetuning requires a large, high quality dataset to be effective.

Minimum recommended: 10,000+ images.

Caption Your Images

Unlike LoRA training, full finetuning uses **no trigger word**. Every image caption should be a descriptive sentence prompt only:

```
A girl with red and yellow heterochromia eyes, black uneven twintails, She is ...
```

💡 **Tip:** Use **JoyCaption** for natural language paragraph-style captioning. Trigger word adder tool can be downloaded from **Here**.

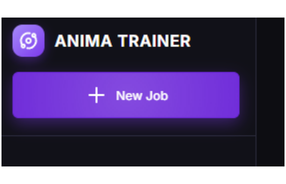
Save all captions as `.txt` files alongside their matching images in a single folder:

```
C:\dataset\concept\
├── image_001.jpg
├── image_001.txt
├── image_002.jpg
├── image_002.txt
...
```

🆕 Step 2 — Create a New Job

Launch the Web UI (`training-ui\start_windows.bat`) and open `http://localhost:3000`.

Click `+ New Job` to create a new training job and give it a name.



⚙️ Step 3 — Training Tab

Anima Model Paths

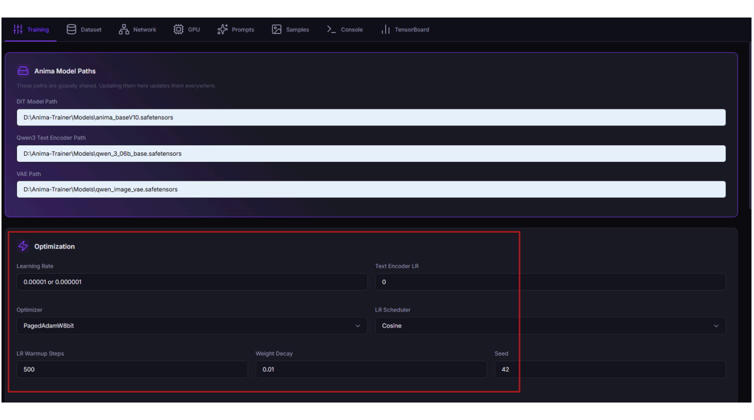
Verify all three model paths at the top of the Training tab are pointing to your downloaded weights:

- **DiT Model Path:** `...\Models\anima_baseV10.safetensors`
- **Qwen3 Text Encoder Path:** `...\Models\qwen_3_06b_base.safetensors`
- **VAE Path:** `...\Models\qwen_image_vae.safetensors`

ℹ️ These paths are globally shared — updating them here updates them for all jobs.

Optimization

- **Learning Rate:** `0.00001` or `0.000001` (can go more lower if you have too many images but don't go too low ui will show error to avoid too long training time)
- **Text Encoder LR:** `0`
- **Optimizer:** `PagedAdamW8bit`
- **LR Scheduler:** `Cosine`
- **LR Warmup Steps:** `500`
- **Weight Decay:** `0.01`
- **Seed:** `42`



🖼️ Step 4 — Dataset Tab

Dataset Settings

- **Resolution:** `1536`
- **Batch Size:** `1`
- **Gradient Accumulation:** `1`
- **Caption Extension:** `.txt`
- **Alpha Mask Loss:** Off

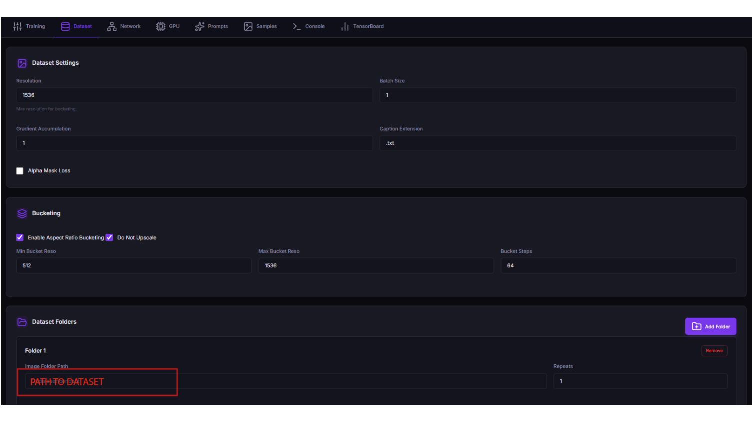
Bucketing

- **Enable Aspect Ratio Bucketing:** ✅
- Enabled **Do Not Upscale:** ✅
- Enabled **Min Bucket Reso:** `512`
- **Max Bucket Reso:** `1536`
- **Bucket Steps:** `64`

Dataset Folders

Click **Add Folder** and set the **Image Folder Path** to your dataset folder. Set **Repeats** to `1` — with a large dataset you do not need repeats.

⚠️ As shown in the UI — make sure to enter the correct **PATH TO DATASET** in the Image Folder Path field.



🧬 Step 5 — Network Tab

Training Type: Full Fine-Tune (Entire Model)

Freeze LLM Adapter: ✅ Enabled — the adapter is pre-trained and retraining it risks degrading text understanding.

Schedule

- **Duration Unit:** Steps
- **Max Steps:** `what ever you prefer`
- **Save Every N Steps:** `what ever you prefer`
- **Output Name:** Your model name
- **Save Format:** Safetensors

📌 Note: Finetuning uses **Steps** as the duration unit, not Epochs.

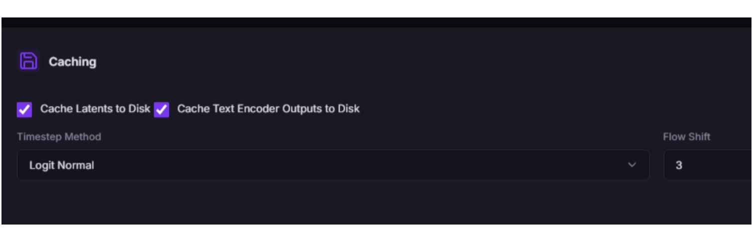
Performance

- **Mixed Precision:** BFloat16
- **Save Precision:** BFloat16
- **DataLoader Workers:** `4`
- **Gradient Checkpointing:** ✅
- Enabled **Flash Attention:** Off
- **Low RAM Mode:** Off
- **Blocks to Swap:** `0`
- **Activation Offload:** None

💾 If you are low on VRAM, enable both **Flash Attention** and **Low RAM Mode**.

Caching

- **Cache Latents to Disk:** ✅ Enabled
- **Cache Text Encoder Outputs to Disk:** ✅
- Enabled **Timestep Method:** Logit
- Normal **Flow Shift:** `3`



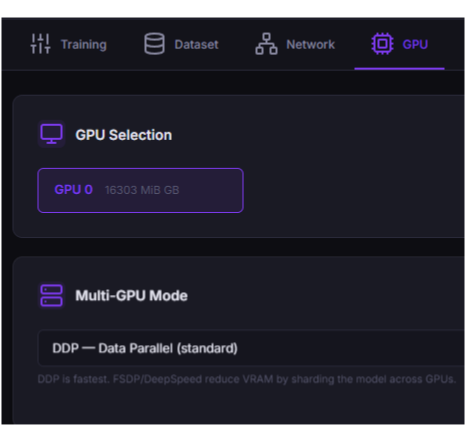
Resume Training

Auto-resume from Last Saved State: ✅ Enabled

ℹ️ As noted in the UI — this will automatically resume from the last saved state **as long as the state folder exists**. Leave the Resume State Folder field blank when auto-resume is enabled.

🖥️ Step 6 — GPU Tab

Under **Multi-GPU Mode**, leave it as **DDP — Data Parallel (standard)**. If you are running multiple GPUs on RunPod, FSDP or DeepSpeed will reduce VRAM by sharding the model across GPUs.



🎨 Step 7 — Prompts Tab

- **In-Training Sampling**: **Enable Sampling During Training** ✅
- Enabled **Sample Every N Epochs:** `5 or whatever interval you prefer`
- **Test Generation Checkpoint:** Select a checkpoint from the dropdown to test
- Click **Generate** to produce a test image.

⚠️ The Generate button **only works if the model is not currently under training.**

Sample Prompts: Click **Add Prompt** to add your test prompts.

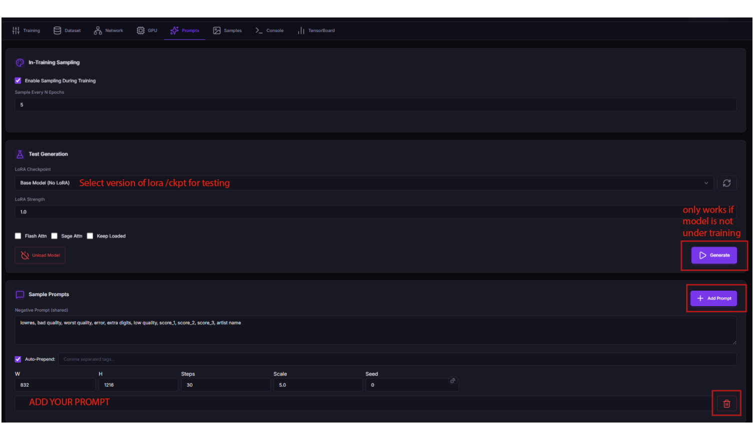
- Fill in a **Auto-Prepend** (shared across all sample prompts):

  ```
  score_10_up, score_9_up, score_9, masterpiece, UHD, Anime screencap, anime screenshot, anime coloring, anime artstyle
  ```

- Fill in the **Negative Prompt** field:

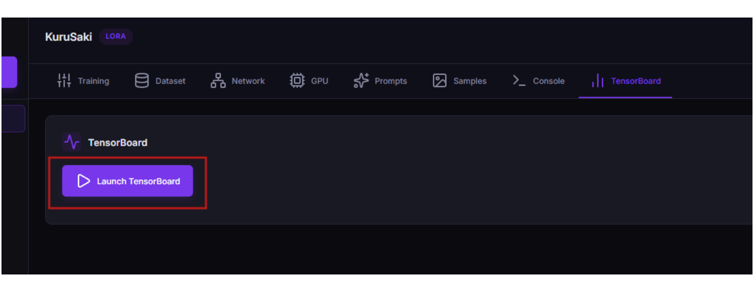
  ```
  lowres, bad quality, worst quality, error, extra digits, low quality, score_1, score_2, score_3, artist name
  ```

- For seed, A dice button is given on the edge of seed parameter box, incase you wanna set seed to any random number
- Set your sample resolution (e.g. `W: 832, H: 1216`), Steps (`30`), Scale (`5.0`), Seed (e.g.`0`).
- Add your descriptive prompt at the bottom — since there is no trigger word for finetuning, use a descriptive sentence only.



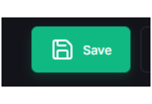
📊 Step 8 — Monitor with TensorBoard

This opens TensorBoard (takes a few seconds to start) in a new browser tab showing your loss curves in real time. It automatically finds a free port — no manual setup needed.



💾 Step 9 — Save and Start Training

Click the **Save** button to save your job configuration, then hit **Start Training**. The **Console** tab shows live output and the **Samples** tab populates with generated images at your chosen interval.



Note: If you're using RunPod, do use my **referral link**! ❤️